UTN
Facultad Regional Córdoba

TUP

Tecnicatura Universitaria en Programación

INGLÉS I

Unidad Temática N° 1:
Frase Nominal

Actividad Complementaria IV
1° Año – 2° Cuatrimestre

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Qualifying and Comparing

A - Choosing a computer

How to make the right decision

What to look for in a computer? How much do I need to spend? Where should I start?

Top Personal Computer hopes to help you make the right decision.

The first question you have to ask yourself is what you'll use the computer for. Then you can decide what system will fit your needs by considering the following factors:

The quality you need and the price you are willing to pay: you can buy a **low-end**, mid-range or **high-end** computer.

Three basic features make a big difference: the CPU speed, the amount of RAM and the size of the hard drive. To run **highly demanding** applications you'll need a **fast** processor, **plentiful** RAM and a **spacious** disk.

If you already have peripherals and software, you'll have to ensure they are **compatible** and can be used with the new computer.

If you want to use the system for some time, it should be **expandable**, i.e. it should allow you to add on new peripherals.

Most standard computers offer **integrated**, built-in, sound cards. If you're keen on music you should also buy **separate**, external, speakers.

Finally, make sure the system you buy is **reliable**, i.e. it's not likely to go wrong. Check that you will receive a warranty and good technical support.

B - Comparing qualities

Comparing and finding differences or similarities are common functions in ICT. When you want to buy a new device, or you read articles about the latest computer or mobile phone, or need to make a decision about the most suitable ICT system for you, you may have to use and understand expressions like the ones in these examples.

COMPARISON

A flat-panel monitor is **slim*mer*** **than** a CRT.
A PDA is ***more*** manageable **than** a laptop.
Laser printers offer **high*er*** quality **than** ink-jet models, but ink-jet printers cost ***less*** money.
You can type ***more*** easily with a separate keyboard.
Free programs are ***as*** good **as** proprietary ones.
A broadband line is ***the best*** option to download multimedia.
The more memory you have, ***the*** **fast*er*** you´ll be able to load your files.

CONTRAST

While a dial-up connection is usually cheap, it is very slow.
A scanner can be useful, **but** it isn´t an essential peripheral.
Unlike CRT monitors, TFT ones are light.

SIMILARITY

Both brand name and clone computers have **similar** features.
Online shops **as well as** local retailers offer good value hardware.

1. **Complete the extracts with adjectives from exercise A above.**

I wanted a powerful computer to work with (1) _____ _____ multimedia applications, so I decided to buy a (2) _____ computer with a (3) _____ microprocessor, good graphics and sound cards and (4) _____ RAM.

I didn´t know whether to buy a new or a used desktop. I just need it to write documents, but I was advised to buy as much as I could afford. Finally, I bought a (5) _____ but new desktop with 256 megabytes of memory, enough for my needs.

I didn´t want my new computer to become outdated too quickly. That´s why I made sure it would be easily (6) _____ with enough space for add-in cards.

2. Complete these sentences with adjectives from exercise A above.

1. Although many computers on the market have hard disk drives with a capacity of 80 to 160 GB, many home users want more _____ drives because of their need for additional storage.
2. This "Wireless Enterprise Communication" is the first realistic alternative to carrying around _____ devices. It offers an _____ mobile phone, GPS, barcode reader and hand-held computer.
3. Before you subscribe to a music subscription service, make sure you have a _____ player that supports the music formats available.
4. Systems and devices are becoming more and more _____ because reliability means manufacturers save money by having fewer tech support calls.

3. Complete the text about the advantages and disadvantages of laptops and desktops with the words from exercise B above.

(1) _____ desktops and laptops have (2) _____ components, but they are built in a different way.
(3) _____ desktops have (4) _____ space to expand the system: they are less manageable (5) _____ laptops. On the other hand, laptops are fully portable: they are lighter and (6) _____ and more practical if you travel a lot and need to take your computer with you.
(7) _____ desktops, the screen, the keyboard and mouse of a laptop are integrated. However, most laptop owners prefer to have a separate mouse (8) _____ the touchpad. Similarly, as the keyboard is miniaturized, some people buy an external one for use at home. You can type (9) _____ easily if you use a full-size keyboard.
A laptop´s CPU is slower (10) _____ access to data may be quicker, so its performance can be (11) _____ good as a desktop´s.
It´s hard to say what the (12) _____ option is. But remember: in the computer world, (13) _____ smaller the device, the more money it costs.

Bibliografía

Marco Fabré, E. & S. Remacha Esteras. (2007). *Professional English in Use ICT* (Intermediate to Advanced). Cambridge, UK. Cambridge University Press.

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